

VO7 Virtual Cybersecurity/Digital Forensics

Description & Eligibility

Contestants will demonstrate knowledge of computer security and cybersecurity management tasks in multiple computer and mobile platforms. This national event involves multiple rounds including judged components on-site at the National Leadership Conference. Awards will be presented at the National Leadership Conference. Any middle level, secondary or postsecondary contestant may enter this event. There are no restrictions on the number of entries per chapter or per state. Contestants who do not submit an entry following the topic listed below or do not follow the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and the Artificial Intelligence Usage and Citation Policy will be disqualified.

Topic (*Top 20 contestants from Round 1 only*)

Follow the Money: Tracing Crime Through Cryptocurrency. Your task is to explore how investigators track illicit funds across blockchains when criminals think crypto makes them anonymous. Examples may include:

- How blockchain's public ledger becomes a permanent paper trail
- Tools and techniques like wallet clustering and chain analysis (e.g., Chainalysis)
- Real cases where crypto tracing cracked ransomware or dark web operations

Competition Notes

- AI Policy Level 2 *Permitted with Citation*
- Contest Registration
 - Advisors register members for the event using the Membership Registration System, accessible at <https://register.bpa.org>
 - Click on the "Conferences" tab and then select the "2027 National Virtual Events"
 - There will be a \$10 fee for each entry (*invoiced during event registration*)
 - Event registration can be purchased with your original invoice or with a new invoice after contestant registration
 - The registration deadline is no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time, on December 1, 2026
 - Contestants participating in the competition must be registered for the event prior to the submission deadline to be eligible

Contest Competencies

1. Identify and assess security threats, applying layered security tactics to prevent, detect, and respond to external attacks
2. Demonstrate knowledge of infrastructure security and organizational security principles to safeguard systems, data, and operations at both a technical and policy level
3. Apply cryptography, access control, and authentication techniques to protect data integrity, confidentiality, and system access
4. Harden Windows, Linux, and network devices and services by applying security best practices and configuration controls to reduce vulnerabilities
5. Demonstrate knowledge of TCP/IP, network defense fundamentals, and wireless technologies to secure and monitor network communications
6. Develop and implement security policies, conduct risk analysis, and configure router and access control lists to establish and enforce organizational security standards
7. Demonstrate knowledge of Internet security issues and biometrics as they apply to identity verification and web-based threat mitigation
8. Manage certificates and monitor security infrastructure to maintain compliance, ensure system integrity, and respond to emerging threats

Contest Specifications for this Event

- Round 1 will consist of contestants completing a 50-question objective test. Contestants will have no more than sixty (60) minutes to complete the objective test. Contestants must also complete the Capture the Flag activities as part of Round 1.
- The top 20 contestants from Round 1 will be invited to create a presentation on the provided topic. The presentation should make effective use of current multimedia technology (e.g., sound, movement, digital video, etc.)
- Advisors of qualifying contestants will be contacted to reserve a time for a videoconference presentation before a panel of judges. The dates and times for presentation reservations will be announced via email notification. Contestants will be assigned to sections prior to the preliminary presentation
- The top contestants with the highest cumulative technical and presentation scores will be invited to attend the National Leadership Conference to be recognized for their outstanding efforts and to participate in the National Showcase
- The presentation length three (3) minutes for setup, no more than ten (10) minutes for the presentation, and no more than five (5) minutes for judges' questions

Common Specifications for all BPA Judged Events

- Contestant ID is required for all submissions. Materials from non-registered members and/or those missing Contestant ID cannot be accepted.
- The contestant is responsible for securing a BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including oneself, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The contestant is responsible for citing all sources, including oneself, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright law. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for Copyright and/or Fair Use. Contestants will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines.
- Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level. Materials submitted for technical judging will *not* be returned and will *not* be available at NLC.

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Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Contestant followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Contestant followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and the Artificial Intelligence Usage & Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 1-5 points	Meets Expectations 6-10 points	Above Expectations 11-20 points	Points Awarded
Opening & Summary	The introduction is unclear or missing, and the summary lacks relevance or completeness.	The introduction sets the stage appropriately, and the summary covers the main points with adequate clarity.	The introduction is engaging and well-structured, and the summary provides a clear, insightful wrap-up that reinforces key findings.	/20
Stated Objectives	Objectives are vague, incomplete, or missing.	Objectives are stated clearly and align with the topic.	Objectives are precise, well-articulated, and demonstrate a strong understanding of the project's purpose.	/20
Use of Technical Language	Technical terms are misused, unexplained, or absent, leading to confusion.	Technical terms are used correctly and explained sufficiently to support understanding.	Technical terms are used accurately and effectively, with clear explanations that enhance communication and demonstrate depth of knowledge.	/20
Content Knowledge	Demonstrates limited understanding with inaccurate or irrelevant content.	Shows adequate understanding with mostly accurate and relevant content.	Demonstrates strong understanding with consistently accurate, detailed, and insightful content.	/20
Visual Design & Communication	Typography and graphics are distracting, inconsistent, or do not support the message.	Typography and graphics are appropriate and contribute to clear communication.	Typography and graphics are thoughtfully designed, enhancing both clarity and the progression of ideas.	/20
Data Visualization	Charts and graphs are missing, poorly constructed, or fail to support the content.	Charts and graphs are appropriate, accurate, and help clarify key points.	Charts and graphs are well-integrated, visually clear, and enhance understanding through effective data presentation.	/20
Verbal Delivery	Voice is unclear or monotone, and diction hinders understanding.	Voice is clear and appropriately paced, with generally effective diction.	Voice is confident and engaging, with precise diction that enhances clarity and professionalism.	/20
Presence & Engagement	Appears unsure or disengaged, with little to no eye contact or assertiveness.	Demonstrates adequate confidence and assertiveness, with consistent eye contact.	Shows strong presence with confident delivery, assertive communication, and engaging eye contact that supports audience connection.	/20

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Presentation Scoring Rubric (Cont'd)

Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-13 points	Meets Expectations 14-27 points	Above Expectations 28-40 points	Points Awarded
Theme Development	The theme is unclear or inconsistently developed, lacking focus or connection.	The theme is clearly stated and developed with logical progression and relevant support.	The theme is thoroughly developed with strong coherence, depth, and consistent alignment to the topic.	/40
Judges Questions	Responses lack depth and fail to demonstrate a comprehensive understanding of the topic.	Some responses lack detail or clarity. The understanding of the topic is partially demonstrated.	Responses are detailed, insightful, and effectively address the judges' questions.	/40
Timing	Setup lasted no longer than three (3) minutes, and the presentation lasted no more than seven (7) minutes.			/10
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/250

Props and/or additional items shall not be used as a basis for scoring.

PRESENTATION WILL BE STOPPED AT SEVEN (7) MINUTES